down. China eventually agreed to stop the road-building, and India agreed to dismantle an observation tower and bunkers. In 2015, at Burtse, Indian troops demolished a Chinese surveillance structure, leading to another stand-off. The PLA called up reinforcements as did the Indian Army. The matter was resolved locally after a week of negotiations. The two armies capped the resolution of the confrontation by a twelve-day joint training exercise.

Then on 16 June 2017, the Indian Army, with Bhutan's permission, stopped a Chinese unit from extending a road in Doklam. Following intense high-level negotiations, the stand-off ended with both sides returning to pre–16 June positions. Nevertheless, a few months later China had built even more infrastructure including a helipad on its side of the line and installed a much larger and more permanent troop presence.[121] August 2017 featured another confrontation that has receded from memory. Just as Doklam was being resolved, a melee occurred between Indian and Chinese troops at Pangong Tso – the same lake which featured so prominently in the 2020 crisis – where the two sides fought with sticks, stones, and rods. This may have been provoked by India's allowing Lobsang Sangay to unfurl the Tibetan flag there in July 2017 in the midst of the Doklam crisis.

Finally, from April–May 2020 onward Indian and Chinese troops once again faced off in Ladakh, this time in a broad area from Depsang in the north down to Pangong Tso, with several intermediate areas included among the flashpoints. While there is intense speculation on the reasons for the 2020 confrontation, a growing Indian view backed by Chinese public statements is that infrastructure building, this time by India, seems to have sparked the row. As India's new road from Leh to Daulat Beg Oldie (which terminates just short of the Karakoram Pass in China) neared completion, Chinese troops moved into Galwan in areas the Indian Army has patrolled without incident since 1962. On 15 June, twenty Indian soldiers and an unconfirmed number of Chinese soldiers died in a brutal melee that lasted several hours in subzero temperatures at over 4000 metres – the first casualties between India and China since the border incident in 1975.